



the basic
argument



allowable
evils

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

what is
omnipotence?

the
argument
reformulated

God is omnipotent.

God is wholly good.

Some evil exists.

If something is wholly good, it always eliminates as much evil as it can.

If something is omnipotent,
it can do anything.

Now our question is: why does Mackie think that these five claims are
contradictory?

To answer this, we can begin by thinking about the claims that God is omnipotent and that God is wholly good. If you think about it, what these claims say can be split into two parts. They first say that God exists and, second, say that if God exists, then God is a certain way.

So we can replace these two claims with the following three:



God is omnipotent.

God is wholly good.

somevixists.



as niches in air.

If something is widely

good, it always reminds



If something is important,

it can do anything.

contradictory?

Now our question is: why does Mackie think that these five claims are

omnipotent and that God is wholly good. If you think about it, what the

claim say can be split into two parts. They first say that God exists and,

To answer this, we can begin by thinking about the claim that God is

second, say that if God exists, then God is a certain way.



evildoers.

9*. Some points less



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**what is
omnipotence?**

There are two especially important arguments against belief in God.



cairibiriing about

2: If something



is important, it

any possible

2. If something is on it,



do anything. (1,2)

it can do anything.

4. If God exists, then God is

3. If God exists, then God can

1. If God exists, then God is

7. If God exists, then God

evaluates God's air. (4,5)

prints even as it can.

5*. If something is wholly good,

9*. Some principles exist.

no point less evi1. (7)

6. If God exists, then God

8. If God exists, then there is

wholly good.

elinitatesas much printless

it always initiates as much

C. God does not exist. (8,9)

(3,6)

elinites all point less vii.



A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "what is omnipotence?" is written in a white, lowercase, sans-serif font, centered horizontally and vertically.

what is
omnipotence?

the
argument
reformulated

So attention naturally focuses on premise (5).



as in the visit card.

5. If something is wholly

good, it always reminds



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evils**



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Some evil exists.



If something is wholly good, it always eliminates as much evil as it can.



If something is omnipotent,
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